◁ Ryan X-13 Vertijet 1955

Origin US

Engine 10,000 lb (4,536 kg) thrust Rolls-Royce Avon turbojet

Top speed 350 mph (563 km/h)

Built to test vertical takeoff, and horizontal to vertical (and back) flight transition, the successful X-13 might have been launched from submarines, but the US Navy never ordered any.

△ Leduc 022 1955

Origin France

Engine 7,040 lb (3,193 kg) thrust SNECMA Atar 101D-3 turbojet + 14,300 lb (6,486 kg) thrust Leduc ramjet

Top speed 750 mph (1,207 km/h)

René Leduc worked through WWII on ramjet-powered designs; his first one—the Leduc 0.10—flew, launched from a mother aircraft, in 1946. The Leduc 022 had a turbojet as well for takeoff, but drag restricted its top speed.

▽ Nord 1500 Griffon 1955

Origin France

Engine 7,710 lb (3,497 kg) thrust ATAR 101E-3 turbojet + 15,290 lb (6,935 kg) thrust Nord Stato-Réacteur ramjet

Top speed 1,450 mph (2,333 km/h)

Using a turbojet for takeoff supplemented by a ramjet for sensational high-speed performance proved successful for the 1500. It was excessively expensive compared to simpler afterburning turbojets.

△ Fairey FD2 1954

Origin UK

Engine 9,300–13,100 lb (4,218–5,942 kg) thrust Rolls-Royce RA28 Avon afterburning turbojet

Top speed 1,147 mph (1,846 km/h)

Built for the UK Ministry of Supply as a supersonic research aircraft, the tail-less delta-winged FD2 was the first aircraft to exceed 1,000 mph (1,609 km/h). To aid vision, it had a tilting nose like Concorde.

△ Saunders-Roe SR53 1957

Origin UK

Engine 1,640 lb (744 kg) thrust Armstrong Siddeley Viper 8 turbojet + 8,000 lb (3,629 kg) thrust de Havilland Spectre rocket

Top speed 1,632 mph (2,626 km/h)

The UK Air Ministry wanted an ultra-rapid-climb interceptor to counter the Cold War bomber threat: this rocket/jet-powered prototype flew well, but ground-to-air missiles were chosen instead.

△ Payen Pa49 Katy 1957

Origin France

Engine 300 lb (136 kg) thrust Turbomeca Palas turbojet

Top speed 311 mph (500 km/h)

Roland Payen championed tail-less delta-winged aircraft. He built several prototypes of which the wood-framed Katy was the first of its kind in France. It was the smallest jet-powered aircraft of its day.

◁ SNECMA C.450 Coléoptère 1959

Origin France

Engine 8,140 lb (3,692 kg) thrust SNECMA Atar 101-EV turbojet

Top speed N/A

French experiments with vertical takeoff centered on this innovative “tail-sitter,” which used a $10\frac{1}{2}$ ft (3.2 m) diameter annular wing. It hovered successfully but crashed when attempting transition to horizontal flight.